TOOL 05

AI Bookkeeper

See your money every week without opening a spreadsheet

What it does

- Watches two folders in Google Drive. One is for money coming in. One is for bills going out.
- Reads each new invoice with AI. It pulls out who it is from, the date, the amount and the tax.
- Sends the owner a short chat message for every new invoice. Money in just shows the amount. A bill comes with two buttons: "Paid" or "Not paid."
- Keeps reminding you about bills that are not paid until you mark them paid.
- Shows a simple dashboard: money in, money out, profit, and tax (like VAT) for each week and month.
- Lets you open any invoice in one tap to check it.

Why it's built this way

Spreadsheets are boring, and accounting apps feel like a second job. So the numbers get checked once a year, when it is too late.

This tool is "stupid simple" on purpose. Here is what we left out and why:

- **It does not pay anything.** It only reads and reminds. Paying stays with you and your bank. That keeps it safe.
- **No new app to learn.** Your team already drops files in Google Drive and you already use a chat app. The tool works with what you have.
- **No accounting words.** You see "money in," "money out" and "profit." Your accountant can still get the full list at the end of the month.
- **No typing.** AI reads the invoice for you. You only tap a button.
- **Two folders, not twenty.** In or out. That is the only choice anyone has to make.

It is not a replacement for your accountant. It is a clear window into your money, every single week.

What you need

- **Google Drive** with two shared folders. You probably have this already. Free, or about $7 a month per person with Google Workspace.
- **A Google service account** so the tool can read the folders. Free.

- **An AI account** to read the invoices. Claude or ChatGPT through their API. For about 50 invoices a month, this is usually $1 to $5.
- **A Telegram bot** for the messages and buttons. Free.
- **A small database** to store the invoice details. Supabase free plan, or about $25 a month on the paid plan.
- **A place to host it** and run a check every few minutes. Vercel, free or about $20 a month.
- **An AI helper to build it.** Claude Code, Cursor or ChatGPT. About $20 a month.

Rough total: **$1 to $50 a month**. For one business with about 50 invoices a month, it can save 3 to 10 hours.

Build it step by step

Paste these one at a time. Test each step with two or three old or fake invoices.

1. Start the project.

```
I'm not a programmer. Help me build a small invoice tracker with Next.js and
Supabase, explained in plain words. First, create an "invoices" table: money
in or out, date, company, amount, VAT, category, paid (yes or no), file link.
```

1. Connect Google Drive.

```
Connect two Google Drive folders, "Money In" and "Money Out", with a Google
service account. Walk me through creating it and sharing the folders. Then
list any new PDFs we have not saved yet. Keep the key out of the code.
```

1. Let AI read each invoice.

```
Send each new PDF to the Claude API. Ask for company, invoice number, date,
total, VAT, currency and a category (rent, salary, services, tax, other).
Save it. If the AI is not sure about the amount, mark it "needs a check".
```

1. Run it on a timer.

```
Run the Drive check every 10 minutes. Never save the same file twice. Show
me how to test it by hand first.
```

1. Send a message for each new invoice.

```
Create a Telegram bot. For each new invoice, message me. Money in: show the
company and amount. Money out: add "Paid" and "Not paid" buttons. A tap
updates the invoice and the message.
```

1. Add reminders for unpaid bills.

```
Every morning at 9am, send me the unpaid bills, oldest first, each with a
"Paid" button. Stop once a bill is paid. Mark bills older than 14 days as
"overdue".
```

1. Build the dashboard.

```
Make a phone-friendly dashboard. Show money in, money out, profit and VAT
for the chosen week or month, plus a bar for each of the last 6 months. Add
"Money in" and "Money out" lists; tapping an invoice opens its PDF. Only I
and my finance person can see it.
```

1. Make the month-end easy.

```
Add a button that downloads a month's invoices as a spreadsheet with totals,
so I can send it to my accountant.
```

Make it yours

- **Add more folders.** For example, one for each branch or each company you own.
- **Split money by person.** Tag money in by salesperson to see who brings in the most.
- **Change the reminder time.** Daily, every Monday, or only for bills over a certain amount.
- **Add a second approver.** For big bills, ask a partner to tap "OK" too.
- **Use email instead of Drive.** Forward invoices to one email address and let the tool save them to the right folder.

Watch out for

- **AI can misread numbers.** Check the amount before you tap "Paid," and compare totals with your bank each month.
- **Keep keys secret.** Never paste them into a chat or show them in a video.
- **Duplicate invoices.** The same bill can arrive twice by email and by hand. Check the invoice number and amount before saving a new one.

- **Different currencies.** If you get invoices in dollars and dirhams, decide on one main currency and convert the rest the same way every time.
- **This is not your official books.** Your accountant still needs the real records for tax filings. This tool helps you see, not file.
- **Who can see it.** Only the owner and the finance person should see money pages. Lock them down from day one.